



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 25

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Finish & Stain Application Safety

OVERVIEW:

Oil-based stains, lacquers, varnishes, and solvent-borne topcoats are fire and health hazards that require strict controls during application, storage, and disposal. Spray application in particular creates an atomized, highly flammable aerosol environment that demands elimination of all ignition

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Before any spray finishing operation, the work area must be cleared of all ignition sources — power tools, extension cords and their connections, pilot lights, space heaters, and anything that creates a spark or open flame. The atomized aerosol from spray finishing is explosive at certain concentrations, and this concentration can be reached in an enclosed space very quickly. Do not
2. Respiratory protection during spray finishing requires more than an N95 dust mask. Solvent vapors pass directly through particulate filters. For spray application of oil-based lacquers, varnishes, or stains, you need a respirator equipped with organic vapor cartridges matched to the solvents in your product — check the SDS for the correct cartridge type. A supplied-air respirator provides the
3. Spontaneous combustion is real and it kills people. When linseed oil, tung oil, Danish oil, or other drying-oil-based finishes oxidize and cure on a cloth, they generate heat. A piled or crumpled rag can reach its ignition temperature in as little as a few hours and start a fire with no open flame anywhere nearby. Spread used rags flat in a single layer on a non-combustible surface
4. Static electricity during solvent transfer is a real ignition hazard. When you pour solvent-based products from one metal container to another, friction can generate a static charge, and that charge can discharge as a spark that ignites the vapor. Bond and ground metal containers during transfer by connecting a grounding wire between them before pouring. This dissipates static charge

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: What finish products are we spraying on this project, and what respirator cartridges are required for each one?
- Q2: Where are we disposing of finish-soaked rags at the end of each day on this job?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Hang or spread rags flat to dry — never pile or ball up oily rags
- Dispose of oily rags in an approved water-filled metal container with a lid
- No ignition sources (sparks, flames, smoking) during any spray finishing
- Use supplied-air or OV cartridge respirator during all spray operations
- Ground metal containers during solvent transfers to prevent static sparks

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 25

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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